

Laravel Complete Learning Guide & Curriculum

A structured path from **absolute beginner** to **production-ready Laravel developer**, with hands-on notes and the **TaskForge** example project.

Your environment: PHP 8.2 + Laravel 12 (TaskForge). Laravel 13 requires PHP 8.3+.

How to Use This Guide

1. **Read modules in order** - each builds on the previous (docs/00 -> docs/18).
2. **Code along in TaskForge** - run commands and edit files as each module instructs.
3. **Complete checkpoints** - every module ends with exercises and a self-check quiz.
4. **Track progress** - use the checklist below.

Curriculum Roadmap (~ 16-24 weeks at 10-15 hrs/week)

Phase	Weeks	Modules	Goal
Foundation	1-3	00-02	PHP, tooling, Laravel anatomy
Core Web	4-7	03-06	Routes, views, DB, auth
Intermediate	8-11	07-11	APIs, assets, validation, storage, queues
Advanced	12-14	12-15	Events, cache, testing, security
Production	15-18	16-18	Deploy, monitor, maintain, scale

Progress Checklist

Phase 1 - Foundation

- ☐ Module 00: Environment & first Laravel app
- ☐ Module 01: PHP essentials for Laravel
- ☐ Module 02: Request lifecycle & project structure

Phase 2 - Core Web Development

- ☐ Module 03: Routing & controllers
- ☐ Module 04: Blade templates & layouts
- ☐ Module 05: Database, migrations & Eloquent
- ☐ Module 06: Authentication & authorization

Phase 3 - Intermediate Skills

- ☐ Module 07: REST API development
- ☐ Module 08: Frontend assets (Vite, Tailwind)
- ☐ Module 09: Validation, forms & requests
- ☐ Module 10: File storage & media
- ☐ Module 11: Queues, jobs & scheduling

Phase 4 - Advanced & Production

- [] Module 12: Events, listeners & notifications
 - [] Module 13: Caching & performance
 - [] Module 14: Testing (unit, feature, browser)
 - [] Module 15: Security hardening
 - [] Module 16: Deployment & hosting
 - [] Module 17: Maintenance & monitoring
 - [] Module 18: Advanced patterns & architecture
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Repository Structure

```
laravel/
|-- README.md          <- You are here (curriculum overview)
|-- docs/              <- Detailed learning modules (00-18)
|   |-- 00-getting-started.md
|   |-- 01-php-fundamentals.md
|   |-- ...
|-- taskforge/         <- Example project (task management app)
|-- README.md          <- Project-specific setup & feature map
|-- app/               <- Application code (models, controllers, etc.)
|-- database/          <- Migrations, seeders, factories
|-- resources/views/   <- Blade templates
|-- routes/            <- Web & API routes
|-- tests/             <- PHPUnit tests
|-- deploy/            <- Deployment configs & scripts
```

TaskForge - Example Project

TaskForge is a team task management application that demonstrates every major Laravel concept:

Feature	Laravel Concepts
User registration & login	Breeze, middleware, policies
Projects & tasks CRUD	Resource controllers, Eloquent relationships
Task assignments & comments	Many-to-many, polymorphic relations
Due-date reminders	Queued jobs, mail, scheduling
Activity log	Events, listeners, observers
REST API	API resources, Sanctum tokens
File attachments	Storage, validation
Dashboard stats	Query scopes, caching
Full test suite	Feature & unit tests

Quick Start

```
cd taskforge
cp .env.example .env
php artisan key:generate
php artisan migrate --seed
php artisan serve
```

Visit <http://localhost:8000> - login with `admin@taskforge.test` / password.

See [taskforge/README.md](#) for the full feature map and module cross-references.

Recommended Learning Schedule

Daily (1-2 hours)

- 30 min reading the module
- 45 min coding in TaskForge
- 15 min review & notes

Weekly

- Complete 1 module
- Run `php artisan test` after each module
- Push a git commit summarizing what you learned

Monthly Milestones

Month	Milestone
1	TaskForge CRUD + auth working locally
2	API endpoints + validation + file uploads
3	Queues, events, 80%+ test coverage
4	Deployed to staging with CI/CD

Essential Resources

Resource	URL
Official Laravel Docs	https://laravel.com/docs
Laracasts (video)	https://laracasts.com
Laravel News	https://laravel-news.com
PHP The Right Way	https://phptherightway.com

Next Step

Open <docs/00-getting-started.md> and begin Module 00.